

Arbitrarily slow critical covering excess in Banach nonembedding obstructions

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A refinement of entry 003 with a full-scope independent model-conducted mathematical audit. The analytic nonembedding argument is inherited from OpenAI family 098. No human peer review, proof-assistant formalization, or optimality claim is implied.

Metric conventions

$B_K(x, R)$ is the closed ball in K . $N_r^K(A)$ is the least number of closed radius- r balls centered in K covering A . Assouad dimension is the infimum of s for which $N_r^K(B_K(x, R)) \leq C_s(R/r)^s$ uniformly in x and $0 < r < R$. Upper box dimension is $\limsup_{r \downarrow 0} \log N_r^K(K) / \log(1/r)$. The main PDF includes entry 003's full supporting proof, including its scale-flexible analytic appendix; the exact original [source snapshot](#) is also bundled.

Theorem

Let $h : [1, \infty) \rightarrow [1, \infty)$ be finite-valued, nondecreasing and tend to infinity. There is a numerical constant C , independent of h and the Banach space, such that every infinite-dimensional real Banach space contains a countable compact set K with all the following properties:

- upper box dimension zero;
- Assouad dimension exactly two;
- doubling constant at most $1 + 5 \cdot 76800^8$;
- no bi-Lipschitz embedding into any finite-dimensional normed space;
- for every x in K and $0 < r < R$,

$$N_r^K(B_K(x, R)) \leq C(R/r)^2 h(R/r).$$

- nevertheless there is no finite critical exponent-two covering constant:

$$\sup_{x, 0 < r < R} \frac{N_r^K(B_K(x, R))}{(R/r)^2} = \infty.$$

One can take $C=350000$. The last two properties say the excess above the planar covering rate can be forced to diverge arbitrarily slowly, while remaining necessarily unbounded for this construction. This does not show that Assouad dimension two is the smallest possible nonembedding dimension, and it does not exclude some other obstruction having a genuine exponent-two bound.

Controlled scale choice

Use exactly the scale-flexible sheet construction $S(\rho)$ from entry 003. Its inherited nonembedding proof permits every schedule with $\rho_{j+1} \leq \rho_j/1000$. Its refined intrinsic covering estimate is

$$N_r^S(B_S(x, R)) \leq 1089(R/r)^{25^m}, \quad m = \#\{j : r/16 < \rho_j \leq R\}. \quad (1)$$

Choose $\rho_1 = 2^{-10}$. For every $n \geq 1$ choose $T_{n+1} \geq 1$ with $h(T_{n+1}) \geq 5^{n+1}$. Choose nondecreasing dyadic integers Q_n such that

$$Q_n \geq 1024, \quad Q_n \geq 2^n, \quad Q_n \geq 128T_{n+1}.$$

For an explicit rounding, put $Q_0 = 1$ and choose Q_n as the least power of two no smaller than $\max\{Q_{n-1}, 1024, 2^n, 128T_{n+1}\}$. Put $\rho_{n+1} = \rho_n/Q_n$. All ρ_j are reciprocal dyadic integers. The adjacent ratios tend to infinity, which independently gives Assouad dimension two exactly as in entry 003.

If the active interval in (1) has length $m \geq 2$ and starts at index a , then

$$\frac{R}{r} > \frac{\rho_a}{16\rho_{a+m-1}} = \frac{Q_a \cdots Q_{a+m-2}}{16} \geq \frac{Q_{m-1}}{16}.$$

The final inequality follows from $a \geq 1$, Q_n nondecreasing and every factor at least one. Thus $(R/r)/8 > T_m$ and $h((R/r)/8) \geq 5^m$. For $m \leq 1$ the bound $5^m \leq 5h(\max\{1, (R/r)/8\})$ is automatic. Therefore

$$N_r^S(B_S(x, R)) \leq 5445(R/r)^2 h(\max\{1, (R/r)/8\}). \quad (2)$$

All constants are independent of h . This is a quantitative refinement of 003, rather than merely its statement that every exponent $s \geq 2$ is available.

Exact finite packing witnesses for nonattainment

For $j \geq 1$ put $q_j = 1/\rho_j$, an integer. Let the planar points be

$$p_{k,l} = ((k + 1/3)\rho_j, (l + 1/3)\rho_j), \quad 0 \leq k, l < q_j.$$

At each level $v \leq j$ the y -coordinate belongs to an open horizontal strip, since ρ_v/ρ_j is an integer and $(l + 1/3)/(\rho_v/\rho_j)$ is not an integer. Choose that strip's color $i_v(p)$. Over each p include all 2^j sheet points with v th coordinate either zero or $\rho_v e_{v, i_v(p)}$, independently. Call their finite set P_j . Then

$$\begin{aligned} |P_j| &= q_j^2 2^j, & P_j &\subset B_S(o, 2), \\ d(p, p') &\geq \rho_j & \text{for distinct } p, p' \in P_j. \end{aligned} \quad (3)$$

The radius assertion follows from the planar square $[0,1]^2$ and $\sum \rho_v^2 \leq \rho_1^2/(1 - 10^{-6}) < 1$. Different planar grid points are ρ_j -separated; points over the same planar point differing in a sheet coordinate

are separated by some $\rho_v \geq \rho_j$. These checks are rational and exact (squared distances may be used). The finite object has an exact compressed specification, although its cardinality need not be practical.

Apply entry 003's finite-witness lemma anew to this chosen $S(\rho)$, obtaining a finite X_j with no distortion-at-most- j embedding into $\mathbb{R}^j$. Enlarge each X_j by P_j and o . The old schedule's point coordinates are not reused. Enlargement cannot remove nonembedding. The qualitative Dvoretzky transfer T_j into the ambient Banach space is normalized to

$$\|u\|_2 \leq \|T_j u\| \leq 2\|u\|_2.$$

Thus $T_j(P_j)$ lies in the radius-four ball about $T_j(o)$, and is ρ_j -separated. At covering radius $\rho_j/3$, any ball, even one centered outside this cluster, can contain at most one of its points. For a translated and scaled cluster with scale τ_j , take

$$R_j = 4\tau_j, \quad r_j = \tau_j \rho_j / 3.$$

The corresponding K -ball therefore satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} N_{r_j}^K(B_K(x_j, R_j)) &\geq q_j^2 2^j, \\ \frac{N_{r_j}^K(B_K(x_j, R_j))}{(R_j/r_j)^2} &\geq \frac{2^j}{144}. \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

Here x_j is the image of o and belongs to K . Additional points and centers elsewhere in K cannot defeat a packing bound. Equation (4) proves the critical exponent-two content is unbounded.

Transfer of the upper gauge through sparse assembly

Let $Y_j = T_j(X_j)$. Recenter the source balls used to cover the preimage of a Y_j -ball at source radius $r/4$, precisely as in 003. Equation (2) gives, with $A_0 = 5445 \cdot 16 = 87120$, the uniform cluster estimate

$$N_r^{Y_j}(B_{Y_j}(y, R)) \leq A_0(R/r)^2 h(\max\{1, R/(2r)\}) \quad (0 < r < R). \tag{5}$$

Place the translated and scaled clusters C_j within $B(a_j v, a_j/100)$, with $a_{j+1} \leq a_j/2$. Also require

$$a_j \leq e^{-j^2}, \quad a_j \leq M_j^{-j}, \quad M_j = \sum_{i \leq j} |X_i|.$$

Let $K = \{0\}$ union the clusters. Entry 003's separation argument gives $\|p - q\| \geq 97a_i/200$ for p in C_i , q in C_j , $i < j$. Its compactness, zero-upper-box-dimension, universal doubling and nonembedding proofs apply unchanged. Adding P_j only changes the finite cardinalities M_j . The Assouad upper bound two still follows from the adjacent sheet ratios Q_j tending to infinity and the same geometric assembly estimate in 003; it does not rely on h being subpolynomial. Equation (4) gives the matching lower bound two directly.

For completeness, (5) yields a universal quantitative K-bound. Put $t=R/r$. If $B_K(x, R)$ meets a cluster with $a_i > 5R$, separation prevents it meeting another cluster or zero. Its intersection lies in a C_i -ball of radius $2R$; (5) covers this by at most

$$4A_0 t^2 h(t) = 348480 t^2 h(t).$$

Otherwise all intersected cluster scales satisfy $a_j \leq 5R$. Clusters with $a_j \leq r/4$ are covered by one radius- r ball at zero. For every remaining cluster, $\text{diameter}(C_j) \leq a_j/50$. If its diameter is at most r , one ball suffices. Otherwise (5) gives a cover costing at most

$$\frac{A_0}{2500} (a_j/r)^2 h(\max\{1, a_j/(100r)\}).$$

The h -factor is at most $h(t)$, since $a_j \leq 5R$. For $a_j > r/4$, the one-ball cost is at most $16(a_j/r)^2 h(t)$. Sum over the geometrically decreasing scales, using

$$\sum_{r/4 < a_j \leq 5R} (a_j/r)^2 \leq (100/3)t^2.$$

Including the tail ball, the second case costs at most

$$[1 + (16 + A_0/2500)100/3]t^2 h(t) < 1696t^2 h(t).$$

The advertised $C=350000$ handles both cases.

Scope

The dimensional and nonembedding dependency is the scale-flexible source argument already checked in 003. The extra finite packing (3) is an exact certificate of critical-covering nonattainment, not a standalone finite certificate of nonembedding into every dimension or of Dvoretzky transfer into an arbitrary Banach space. Upper box dimension zero comes from sparse *global cluster placement*. Assouad dimension and its critical covering content come from *within-cluster scale ratios and branching*. They must not be interchanged.

Primary context: OpenAI family 098, pinned at [adc7f1241b42e322a6451854ab7e4b4c146bf78a](#), supplies the sheet crossing nonembedding argument. Naor and Neiman, Assouad's theorem with dimension independent of the snowflaking, explains why doubling gives embeddings after snowflaking but does not ensure a bi-Lipschitz embedding of the original metric. This refinement neither changes that theorem nor claims a new embedding threshold.

[Pinned primary source Naor–Neiman primary paper](#)

Excess profile and audit

The phrase arbitrarily slow divergence is formalized by the nondecreasing profile $F_K(T) = \sup\{N_r^K(B_K(x, R))/(R/r)^2 : x \in K, 1 < R/r \leq T\}$. It is finite for every finite $T > 1$, satisfies $F_K(T) \leq 350000h(T)$, and tends to infinity by (4). This need not hold along every individual family of balls.

See [the full-scope proof audit](#), [build instructions](#), and [pinned source provenance](#). [Entry 003 source at its immutable pin](#).

Supporting proof from entry 003

This supporting proof is reproduced from the pinned entry-003 source. It contains the full sheet construction, refined covering argument, finite-witness and Dvoretzky transfer, sparse assembly, and analytic crossing proof. Its specific 1000^{-j^2} schedule remains its own example. The gauge theorem above applies the explicitly scale-flexible source lemma and witness argument anew to the new gauge-tailored schedule. No old finite point coordinates are reused. OpenAI family 098 is credited for the inherited analytic mechanism.

S1 Statement and scope

For a metric space X , write $B_X(x, R) = \{y \in X : d(x, y) \leq R\}$. If $E \subseteq X$, let $N_r^X(E)$ be the least number of closed radius- r balls with centers in X that cover E . The *Assouad dimension* is

$$\dim_A X = \inf \left\{ s \geq 0 : \exists C < \infty \forall x \in X \forall 0 < r < R, \quad N_r^X(B_X(x, R)) \leq C(R/r)^s \right\}.$$

For a nonempty compact space, its *upper box dimension* is

$$\overline{\dim}_B X = \limsup_{r \downarrow 0} \frac{\log N_r^X(X)}{\log(1/r)}.$$

A space is λ -doubling if $N_{R/2}^X(B_X(x, R)) \leq \lambda$ for every x, R . A map has distortion at most D if, for some $b > 0$,

$$b d(x, y) \leq \|f(x) - f(y)\| \leq D b d(x, y) \quad (x, y \in X).$$

Theorem S1.1. *There is a numerical constant Λ such that every infinite-dimensional real Banach space B contains a countable compact subset K satisfying*

$$\overline{\dim}_B K = 0, \quad \dim_A K = 2,$$

with doubling constant at most Λ , and with no bi-Lipschitz embedding into any finite-dimensional real normed space. One may take

$$\Lambda = 1 + 5 \cdot 76800^8.$$

The starting point is the OpenAI manuscript *A doubling Hilbert subset with no finite-dimensional bi-Lipschitz embedding* [1], which proves compact doubling obstructions in all infinite-dimensional real Banach spaces. Its finite-cluster assembly already gives a countable set, hence Hausdorff dimension zero. Making those clusters sparse also gives zero upper box dimension without changing the central obstruction. The substantive additional estimate here is exact Assouad dimension two, compatible with the other conclusions.

The original construction uses scales 1000^{-j} . Here they are replaced by 1000^{-j^2} . Section S2 states precisely the inherited nonembedding result in the scale-flexible form needed below. Appendix S7 records the source argument and verifies its scale dependence. Sections S3–S5 contain the refined covering and assembly proofs. The reference is pinned to repository commit

adc7f1241b42e322a6451854ab7e4b4c146bf78a.

This is a research-note argument. It is not a formal verification of the modified construction or a claim that the literature has been exhaustively checked. In particular, the theorem does not assert that Assouad dimension two is the smallest possible dimension for such an obstruction.

S2 The sheet construction and its inherited obstruction

Fix a sequence $(N_j, W_j)_{j \geq 1}$ in $\mathbb{N}^2$ in which every pair occurs infinitely often. For example, concatenate the lists $\{1, \dots, m\}^2$, $m = 1, 2, \dots$. Let (ρ_j) be positive scales satisfying

$$\rho_{j+1} \leq 10^{-3} \rho_j. \quad (1)$$

In the Hilbert direct sum

$$\mathcal{H} = \mathbb{R}^2 \oplus \bigoplus_{j \geq 1} \mathbb{R}^{N_j},$$

write $e_{j,i}$ for the coordinate vectors of the j th summand. At level j , color the open horizontal strips

$$\{(x, y) : q\rho_j < y < (q+1)\rho_j\}, \quad q \in \mathbb{Z},$$

by $i \in \{1, \dots, N_j\}$ when $q \equiv i - 1 \pmod{N_j}$. Color the vertical strips

$$\{(x, y) : qW_j\rho_j < x < (q+1)W_j\rho_j\}$$

in the same way. Denote the unions of color- i strips by $H_{j,i}$ and $V_{j,i}$, and set $U_{j,i} = H_{j,i} \cup V_{j,i}$.

Let $S(\rho) \subset \mathcal{H}$ consist of the points (p, w) for which $w = (w_j)$ has finite support and, independently at each level,

$$w_j = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad w_j = \rho_j e_{j,i} \text{ with } p \in U_{j,i}. \quad (2)$$

The zero coordinate is always permitted, also on strip boundaries. In particular, $S(\rho)$ contains an isometric copy of $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Lemma S2.1 (Scale-flexible source obstruction). *For every schedule satisfying (1), the space $S(\rho)$ has doubling constant at most $\lambda = 76800$ and admits no finite-distortion bi-Lipschitz embedding into $\mathbb{R}^k$, for any positive integer k .*

Source dependency and scale check. The construction and analytic argument are those of [1, Sections 2–5]. The doubling proof uses only (1) and the geometric tail estimate

$$\sum_{\rho_j \leq t} \rho_j^2 \leq \frac{t^2}{1 - 10^{-6}}. \quad (3)$$

For completeness, consider a radius- R ball. Coordinates with $\rho_j > R$ are fixed. There is at most one level with $R/64 < \rho_j \leq R$. The base projection meets at most 129 horizontal and 129 vertical strips at that level, hence fewer than 300 coordinate labels including zero. Divide its base square of side $2R$ into 16^2 cells of side $R/8$. In each group with a common cell and label, the squared diameter is at most

$$2(R/8)^2 + \frac{2(R/64)^2}{1 - 10^{-6}} < (R/2)^2.$$

One point from each nonempty group yields the claimed $300 \cdot 16^2$ intrinsic balls.

For nonembedding, the only scale choice in the source's derivative and crossing proof is the following: after a finite-support sheet, a positive square side l , a fixed color count N , and an integer n are chosen, choose an unused level j with

$$(N_j, W_j) = (N, n), \quad Nn\rho_j < ln^{-8}/100. \quad (4)$$

Infinite recurrence and $\rho_j \rightarrow 0$ give this choice. The horizontal and vertical energy estimates then use this one level and the strip widths $\rho_j, n\rho_j$. They use no further relation between different levels. Appendix S7 gives the estimates and packing contradiction explicitly. Thus the same nonembedding proof applies under (1). $\square$

From now on, fix

$$\rho_j = 1000^{-j^2}, \quad S = S(\rho). \quad (5)$$

This satisfies (1), and the consecutive ratios ρ_j/ρ_{j+1} tend to infinity. Retaining the independently recurring aspect ratios W_j is essential in (4); faster absolute decay does not replace the anisotropy of the source argument.

S3 A refined covering estimate

Proposition S3.1. *There is a numerical constant C such that, for every $x \in S$ and $0 < r < R$,*

$$N_r^S(B_S(x, R)) \leq C(R/r)^2 5^{m(R, r)}, \quad m(R, r) = \#\{j : r/16 < \rho_j \leq R\}. \quad (6)$$

Proof. Different allowed choices at level j have distance at least ρ_j . Thus every coordinate with $\rho_j > R$ agrees with that of x throughout the ball. Partition a base square of side $2R$ containing its projection into cells with side at most $r/16$. This uses at most

$$\lceil 32R/r \rceil^2 \leq 33^2(R/r)^2$$

cells, with boundaries assigned arbitrarily.

At an active level $r/16 < \rho_j \leq R$, each coordinate interval of a cell meets at most two strips in its respective direction: its length is smaller than both strip widths ρ_j and $W_j\rho_j$. Across that cell, at most two horizontal colors and two vertical colors are available. Including zero leaves at most five displacement choices. This bound is independent of N_j and W_j .

Group the ball's points by their base cell and all active coordinates. Within each group, all coarse and active coordinates agree. For two points in a group, the squared fine-coordinate distance is at most

$$2 \sum_{\rho_j \leq r/16} \rho_j^2 \leq \frac{2(r/16)^2}{1 - 10^{-6}} < \frac{r^2}{64}.$$

Their squared base distance is at most $2(r/16)^2 = r^2/128$. The total diameter of a group is therefore less than r . Choosing a point of S in every nonempty group proves (6), with $C = 33^2$. $\square$

Corollary S3.2. *For every $s > 2$ there is $C_s < \infty$ such that*

$$N_r^S(B_S(x, R)) \leq C_s(R/r)^s \quad (x \in S, 0 < r < R). \quad (7)$$

Consequently, $\dim_A S = 2$.

Proof. Fix $\varepsilon = s - 2 > 0$ and put $L = 5^{1/\varepsilon}$. Since consecutive scale ratios tend to infinity, choose J such that $\rho_j/\rho_{j+1} \geq L$ for $j \geq J$. The active levels form a consecutive interval of indices. All but at most $J + 1$ of its $m = m(R, r)$ levels contribute a successive gap of size at least L . If $m > J + 1$, this gives

$$(m - J - 1) \log L \leq \log(16R/r).$$

The resulting estimate also holds when $m \leq J + 1$:

$$5^m \leq 5^{J+1}(16R/r)^\varepsilon.$$

Combine this with (6). It follows that $\dim_A S \leq 2$. The base plane gives the reverse inequality, for instance by planar grid packing. No exponent-two covering bound is needed or asserted. $\square$

S4 Finite witnesses and transfer to Banach spaces

Lemma S4.1. *For each $j \in \mathbb{N}$, there is a finite subset $X_j \subset S$ with no embedding into $\mathbb{R}^j$ of distortion at most j , and containing the planar grid*

$$G_j = \{((a/j, b/j), 0) : a, b \in \{0, \dots, j\}\}. \quad (8)$$

These sets can be chosen before specifying the ambient Banach space or a prospective finite-dimensional target.

Proof. Use the compactness argument of [1, Section 7]. Fix $k \geq 1$ and $D \geq 1$. If every finite subset of S had distortion at most D into $\mathbb{R}^k$, fix $o \in S$ and form the compact product

$$\prod_{x \in S} \{u \in \mathbb{R}^k : \|u\| \leq Dd(o, x)\}.$$

For each pair x, y , impose the closed constraint

$$d(x, y) \leq \|f(x) - f(y)\| \leq Dd(x, y).$$

Any finite collection of constraints involves finitely many points. Include o , normalize the assumed finite embedding to be noncontracting and D -Lipschitz, and translate its value at o to zero. Set unused product coordinates to zero. This verifies the finite-intersection property. Product compactness would produce a forbidden embedding of all of S , contradicting Lemma S2.1.

Apply this with $k = D = j$ and adjoin G_j to the resulting witness. Enlarging a set cannot remove its nonembedding obstruction. $\square$

Fix an infinite-dimensional real Banach space B . The classical finite-dimensional Dvoretzky theorem [2], in the formulation recalled in [3, Theorem 1.1], gives linear maps

$$T_j : \text{span } X_j \longrightarrow B, \quad \|u\|_2 \leq \|T_j u\|_B \leq 2\|u\|_2.$$

Only this qualitative assertion for each finite-dimensional Hilbert space is required. Put $Y_j = T_j(X_j)$.

Lemma S4.2. *Every Y_j has doubling constant at most $\lambda_0 = 76800^4$. For every $s > 2$, all Y_j satisfy an intrinsic exponent- s covering estimate with a common constant A_s , independent of j and B . Both assertions remain true after any translation and positive rescaling of each Y_j separately.*

Proof. The preimage E of a radius- R ball in Y_j , centered at $T_j x$, lies in $B_S(x, R)$. Four applications of Lemma S2.1 cover this source ball by at most λ^4 balls of radius $R/16$. In each one meeting E , select $x_0 \in E$. If x' lies in the same ball, then

$$\|T_j x' - T_j x_0\|_B \leq 2d(x', x_0) \leq R/4 \leq R/2.$$

The selected images give an intrinsic doubling cover.

Similarly, for $0 < r < R$, cover $B_S(x, R)$ by source balls of radius $r/4$, using (7). Re-center every ball meeting E at a point of E . Its selected image is at distance at most $2 \cdot 2(r/4) = r$ from all the other images in that ball. Thus the number required is at most $C_s(4R/r)^s$, uniformly. Translation and rescaling preserve these dimensionless inequalities. $\square$

S5 Sparse compact assembly

Let $n_j = |X_j| = |Y_j|$ and $M_j = \sum_{i=1}^j n_i$. Fix a unit vector $v \in B$ and put $\eta = 1/100$. Choose positive numbers a_j recursively such that

$$a_{j+1} \leq a_j/2, \quad a_j \leq \min\{e^{-j^2}, M_j^{-j}\}. \quad (9)$$

All M_j are fixed in advance, so these requirements are compatible. For each j , choose a translation $t_j \in B$ and a positive scale τ_j for which

$$C_j = t_j + \tau_j Y_j \subset B_B(a_j v, \eta a_j), \quad K = \{0\} \cup \bigcup_{j \geq 1} C_j.$$

Such placement is possible because each Y_j is finite. It has no effect on the uniform constants in Lemma S4.2.

S5.1 Separation and compactness

For $i < j$, and $p \in C_i, q \in C_j$,

$$\|p - q\|_B \geq (a_i - a_j) - \eta(a_i + a_j) \geq \left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{3\eta}{2}\right) a_i = \frac{97}{200} a_i. \quad (10)$$

Also $(1 - \eta)a_j \leq \|p\|_B \leq (1 + \eta)a_j$ for $p \in C_j$. Thus the clusters are disjoint and exclude zero. The set K is countable. Any sequence in K has either a constant subsequence in a finite union of clusters and $\{0\}$, or a subsequence with cluster indices tending to infinity. The latter converges to zero because $a_j \rightarrow 0$. Hence K is compact.

S5.2 Zero upper box dimension

For every sufficiently small $r > 0$, there is a unique j such that

$$2a_{j+1} \leq r < 2a_j.$$

All clusters with index greater than j , together with zero, lie in the single radius- r ball centered at zero. The first j clusters can be covered using their M_j individual points. Consequently,

$$N_r^K(K) \leq M_j + 1, \quad \frac{\log N_r^K(K)}{\log(1/r)} \leq \frac{\log(M_j + 1)}{j \log M_j - \log 2}.$$

Here (9) gives $\log(1/r) > j \log M_j - \log 2$. As $r \downarrow 0$, the associated j tends to infinity; $M_j \geq j$ and the last quotient tends to zero. Thus $\overline{\dim}_B K = 0$. Its Hausdorff dimension is also zero, both by countability and by the box-dimension bound.

S5.3 A universal doubling constant

Fix $x \in K$ and $R > 0$. Clusters with $a_j \leq R/4$, and zero, are covered by $B_K(0, R/2)$, because $(1 + \eta)R/4 < R/2$. Consider

$$I = \{j : C_j \cap B_K(x, R) \neq \emptyset, a_j > R/4\}.$$

If I has at least two indices, let i be its smallest. Apply (10) to points in the two intersections to obtain $a_i \leq 400R/97$. All scales indexed by I then lie in

$$(R/4, 400R/97],$$

whose endpoint ratio is $1600/97 < 32$. Since successive a_j decrease by at least a factor of two, there are at most five such scales. The bound $|I| \leq 5$ also holds when I has at most one index, without any bound on its scale.

For $j \in I$, choose $y_j \in C_j \cap B_K(x, R)$. That intersection is contained in $B_{C_j}(y_j, 2R)$, which two cluster doublings cover by at most λ_0^2 balls of radius $R/2$ with centers in C_j . Together with the tail ball this uses at most

$$1 + 5\lambda_0^2 = 1 + 5 \cdot 76800^8$$

balls centered in K . This proves the advertised universal bound.

S5.4 The upper Assouad estimate

Fix $s > 2$. We prove a uniform exponent- s covering estimate for K . Consider $B_K(x, R)$ and $0 < r < R$.

If the ball meets a cluster C_i with $a_i > 5R$, it cannot meet any other cluster: (10), in either index order, would give distance at least $(97/200)a_i > 2R$ between the two intersections. It cannot contain zero either. Choosing a point in its intersection with C_i , that intersection lies in a C_i -ball of radius $2R$. Lemma S4.2 gives a cover by at most $A_s(2R/r)^s$ balls.

Otherwise, every intersected cluster has $a_j \leq 5R$. Clusters with $a_j \leq r/4$ are covered by the radius- r ball at zero. For each remaining cluster, its diameter is at most $2\eta a_j$. The uniform cluster estimate, or one ball when that diameter is at most r , gives a cover of the entire cluster by at most

$$A'_s \max\{1, (a_j/r)^s\}$$

balls of radius r . On the range $a_j > r/4$, the maximum is at most $4^s(a_j/r)^s$. If j_0 is the first index in $r/4 < a_j \leq 5R$, then $a_{j_0+h} \leq 2^{-h}a_{j_0} \leq 2^{-h}5R$. Hence

$$\sum_{j: r/4 < a_j \leq 5R} \max\{1, (a_j/r)^s\} \leq \frac{4^s 5^s}{1 - 2^{-s}} (R/r)^s.$$

This bounds the full cover by a constant depending only on s times $(R/r)^s$. Since every $s > 2$ is admissible, $\dim_A K \leq 2$.

S5.5 The lower Assouad estimate

The image of G_j in C_j contains $(j+1)^2$ points with pairwise distances at least τ_j/j . They lie in a ball centered at one of these points with radius $3\tau_j$, since $2\sqrt{2}\tau_j < 3\tau_j$. A radius- $\tau_j/(3j)$ ball,

wherever its center lies in K , contains at most one grid point: its diameter is smaller than their separation. If an exponent $s < 2$ were admissible for K , then its covering constant would satisfy

$$(j+1)^2 \leq C \left(\frac{3\tau_j}{\tau_j/(3j)} \right)^s = C(9j)^s \quad (j \geq 1),$$

a contradiction. Thus $\dim_A K \geq 2$. The arbitrarily small placement scales cancel from the ratio of observation radius to mesh size.

S5.6 Nonembedding into every finite-dimensional target

Suppose K embeds bi-Lipschitzly into a finite-dimensional real normed space. The zero-dimensional case is impossible. Otherwise compose with a linear identification of the target with Euclidean $\mathbb{R}^k$. Equivalence of finite-dimensional norms gives a finite distortion D for the composition. Choose an integer $j \geq k$ with $j \geq 2D$. Restrict to C_j and precompose with $x \mapsto t_j + \tau_j T_j x$ on X_j . After the isometric inclusion $\mathbb{R}^k \hookrightarrow \mathbb{R}^j$, the resulting embedding of X_j has distortion at most $2D \leq j$, contrary to Lemma S4.1. This finishes the proof of Theorem S1.1.

S6 What the conclusion does and does not establish

The construction separates global and local covering complexity. Its total covering number grows more slowly than every power as the scale tends to zero, while its finite grid patterns force local Assouad exponent at least two. The nonembedding obstruction resides in the finite witnesses and survives arbitrarily small similarities.

The result is an extension of the stated OpenAI manuscript. The derivative-extremum mechanism, strip crossings, finite-witness compactness, and Dvoretzky transfer are inherited. The refined $5^{m(R,r)}$ estimate, the use of superlacunary scales to obtain exponent $2+\varepsilon$ for every $\varepsilon > 0$, and the compatible grid-enriched sparse assembly supply the dimensional refinement. Zero upper box dimension by itself is a straightforward sparsification of the source's final assembly. Neither a sharp universal lower threshold nor a comprehensive novelty claim follows from this proof. The existing source formalization is not, by itself, a formal proof of the changed scale schedule and the additional dimension statements.

S7 The inherited analytic proof and its scale dependence

This appendix records the derivative and crossing argument of [1, Sections 3–5] for the general schedule of Lemma S2.1. Its purpose is to make the dependency explicit and verify the permissible change of scales. The analytic mechanism is credited to that source. Besides the displayed construction, it uses Rademacher's theorem, Lebesgue differentiation, absolute continuity of Lipschitz maps on line segments, and finite-dimensional Euclidean volume comparison.

S7.1 Sheets and a compact extremal set

Assume, towards a contradiction, that $f : S(\rho) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^k$ satisfies

$$\|z - z'\| \leq \|f(z) - f(z')\| \leq D\|z - z'\|. \quad (11)$$

For a finite-support tuple w , put $\Omega_w = \{p : (p, w) \in S(\rho)\}$. This is the finite intersection of the open sets $U_{j,i}$ corresponding to its nonzero entries. The sheet $F_w(p) = f(p, w)$ is D -Lipschitz on Ω_w , even

if the domain is disconnected. At almost every point it is differentiable and its derivative columns are Lebesgue points. Call these points good. At a good point with columns u, v , the mean of

$$\|(F_w)_x - u\|^2 + \|(F_w)_y - v\|^2$$

over shrinking centered squares tends to zero, since the derivative columns are bounded.

Let $\mathcal{D} \subset [0, D^2]^2$ be the closure of all pairs of squared derivative-column norms at good points of every sheet. It is nonempty and compact. Define its lexicographic maximum by

$$\alpha = \max\{a : (a, b) \in \mathcal{D}\}, \quad \beta = \max\{b : (\alpha, b) \in \mathcal{D}\}.$$

For every $\varepsilon > 0$, compactness gives $\delta > 0$ such that

$$(a, b) \in \mathcal{D}, \quad a > \alpha - \delta \implies b \leq \beta + \varepsilon.$$

Indeed, failure would give a limiting point $(\alpha, b) \in \mathcal{D}$ with $b \geq \beta + \varepsilon$. Consequently, if (a_n, b_n) are $\mathcal{D}$ -valued random variables with $\mathbb{E}(\alpha - a_n) \rightarrow 0$, then

$$\limsup_n \mathbb{E} b_n \leq \beta. \tag{12}$$

To see this, bound the probability of $\alpha - a_n \geq \delta$ by $\mathbb{E}(\alpha - a_n)/\delta$ and use $b_n \leq D^2$ on this exceptional set.

S7.2 Near-extremal rectangles and the sole scale choice

Fix an integer $N > (1 + 2D)^k$. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, choose a sheet F and a good point with columns u, v such that

$$0 \leq \alpha - \|u\|^2 < n^{-4}, \quad |\beta - \|v\|^2| < n^{-4}.$$

Choose a centered square Q^0 of side l , with closure in the sheet domain, on which the mean squared derivative error is less than n^{-8} . Now choose an unused level satisfying (4), and write $\rho = \rho_j$. This is possible for every such sheet and square, because its support is finite, the pair (N, n) recurs infinitely often, and $\rho_j \rightarrow 0$.

Trim Q^0 to a rectangle Q tiled by whole period blocks of width $Nn\rho$ and height $N\rho$. Each side loses at most two periods, so its side lengths L_x, L_y are at least $l/2$. With all following averages over Q ,

$$\langle \|F_x - u\|^2 + \|F_y - v\|^2 \rangle < 4n^{-8}, \quad \frac{\rho}{L_x}, \frac{\rho}{L_y} < \frac{n^{-9}}{50N}. \tag{13}$$

Let F_i be the sheet obtained by adding $\rho e_{j,i}$ at this unused level. It is defined on $\Omega_w \cap U_{j,i}$ and

$$\|F_i - F\| \leq D\rho \quad \text{on } Q \cap (H_{j,i} \cup V_{j,i}). \tag{14}$$

Crucially, its horizontal and vertical restrictions are parts of the same map.

Select $G_H^x = (F_i)_x$ according to the horizontal strip color. Select $G_V^x = (F_i)_x$ and $G_V^y = (F_i)_y$ according to the vertical strip color. Almost everywhere,

$$\|G_H^x\|^2 \leq \alpha, \quad (\|G_V^x\|^2, \|G_V^y\|^2) \in \mathcal{D}.$$

The set $\mathcal{D}$, its maximum, the map f , and N are fixed as n varies.

S7.3 The two energy estimates

For any vector field G and constant vector a ,

$$\langle \|G - a\|^2 \rangle = \langle \|G\|^2 \rangle - \|a\|^2 - 2\langle a, \langle G \rangle - a \rangle. \quad (15)$$

Integrating $F_i - F$ along full horizontal segments in its color strip gives an endpoint error of norm at most $2D\rho$. Fubini, absolute continuity, and (13) imply

$$\|\langle G_H^x \rangle - u\| \leq 2D\rho/L_x + 2n^{-4}.$$

Using (15) and $\|u\| \leq D$ gives

$$\langle \|G_H^x - u\|^2 \rangle \leq (1 + 4D)n^{-4} + 4D^2\rho/L_x.$$

Therefore

$$n^2 \langle \|G_H^x - F_x\|^2 \rangle \leq 2(1 + 4D)n^{-2} + \frac{4D^2}{25N}n^{-7} + 8n^{-6} \longrightarrow 0. \quad (16)$$

The factor n^2 is the one needed for the long horizontal segments.

For the vertical selection, first integrate the horizontal derivative separately across full vertical strips of width $n\rho$. The same endpoint error now gives

$$\|\langle G_V^x \rangle - u\| \leq 2D/n + 2n^{-4}.$$

There is no continuity requirement for the selected field across strip boundaries. Discarding the nonnegative left side of (15), obtain

$$0 \leq \langle \alpha - \|G_V^x\|^2 \rangle \leq (1 + 4D)n^{-4} + 4D^2/n \longrightarrow 0.$$

Equation (12), applied with normalized area on Q , gives

$$\limsup_n \langle \|G_V^y\|^2 \rangle \leq \beta.$$

Each vertical strip spans the height of Q , so integration in the vertical direction also gives

$$\|\langle G_V^y \rangle - v\| \leq 2D\rho/L_y + 2n^{-4} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since $\|v\|^2 \rightarrow \beta$ and $\|v\| \leq D$, equation (15) implies $\langle \|G_V^y - v\|^2 \rangle \rightarrow 0$. Combining with the base derivative error yields

$$\langle \|G_V^y - F_y\|^2 \rangle \longrightarrow 0. \quad (17)$$

No quantitative modulus in (12) is needed. The strip width $n\rho$ supplies the $1/n$ deficit bound, independently of the absolute value of ρ .

S7.4 Crossings and Euclidean packing

Choose a period block $P \subset Q$ on which the mean combined energy

$$n^2 \|G_H^x - F_x\|^2 + \|G_V^y - F_y\|^2$$

is at most its mean on Q . Call this block average ε_n . By (16) and (17), $\varepsilon_n \rightarrow 0$. The block contains one row and one column of each color. In each color- i row choose a horizontal line $y = y_i$ satisfying

$$\frac{1}{Nn\rho} \int n^2 \|(F_i - F)_x\|^2 dx \leq 2N\varepsilon_n.$$

In its column choose a vertical line $x = x_i$ satisfying

$$\frac{1}{N\rho} \int \|(F_i - F)_y\|^2 dy \leq 2N\varepsilon_n.$$

Fubini permits these independent choices in the full-measure set of lines on which partial and line derivatives agree. If $\varepsilon_n = 0$, use zero-energy lines. Endpoint values are interpreted by the Lipschitz one-sided limits.

Set $h_i = (F_i - F)/\rho$. Absolute continuity and Cauchy–Schwarz show that the oscillation of h_i on either chosen line is at most

$$\omega_n = N\sqrt{2N\varepsilon_n} \rightarrow 0.$$

Let $z_i = h_i(x_i, y_i)$; then $\|z_i\| \leq D$ by (14). For $i \neq m$, both labels $\rho e_{j,i}$ and $\rho e_{j,m}$ are permitted at (x_m, y_i) , the first by the row and the second by the column. Their source distance is $\sqrt{2}\rho$, so (11) gives

$$\|h_i(x_m, y_i) - h_m(x_m, y_i)\| \geq \sqrt{2}.$$

Moving along row i and column m therefore yields

$$\|z_i - z_m\| \geq \sqrt{2} - 2\omega_n > 1$$

for all pairs when n is sufficiently large. No differentiability at the crossing points is needed, since the oscillation estimates hold at every point on the chosen lines.

The N disjoint open radius-1/2 balls around these vectors lie in the radius- $(D + 1/2)$ ball in $\mathbb{R}^k$. Volume comparison gives $N \leq (1 + 2D)^k$, contradicting the fixed choice of N . This proves the nonembedding part of Lemma S2.1. The only level selection was (4); all subsequent estimates involve that level alone.

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